DIGISQUARES

Accelerating Digital Transformation with Low-Code/No-Code Automation

Low-Code/No-Code Automation

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Digital Transformation Becomes Everyone's Business with Low-Code Development

Digital Transformation is more important than ever in the aftermath of COVID-19. Indeed, the global epidemic has served as a wake-up call for both large and small businesses as they battle with the challenges of fast adapting to a dramatically altered business paradigm and customer landscape. Organizations with the digital agility to pivot quickly, more than any other element, are currently rising above the competition and putting themselves on a path to success. Traditional approaches to software and service delivery are no longer sufficient, especially with an increasingly virtual workforce and consumers' ever-increasing digital expectations.

Organizations must execute faster in a digitally transformed economy, incorporate new degrees of automation into business processes, and ultimately inspire consumers, workers, and partners with compelling experiences that offer exactly what they need when they need it. Low-code development is, by all accounts, the best method. Companies that use low-code platforms can efficiently expand and expedite app delivery by involving everyday employees and other business stakeholders in their development activities, rather than depending primarily on expert developers. Low-code cuts total IT expenses while increasing worker productivity and efficiency enormously due to the increased degrees of automation reached by enabling teams of less trained citizen developers.

The proper low-code platform should act as a point of integration for the entire organization, integrating all systems, applications, users, and data in new ways to help the company grow. It must also provide comprehensive visibility into end-to-end processes, as well as insights to assist you in achieving enterprise-grade performance, dependability, security, resilience, and compliance.

A low-code platform that is highly automated and scalable can have a substantial impact on the bottom line. Business processes can move faster with more optimized workflows, which means you can double production without hiring more people or serve twice as many consumers in half the time. Low-code technologies make it simple for both developers and non-developers to engage with code. Visual modeling and drag-and-drop interfaces are used in these. The technologies are preferred by enterprise customers with some programming skills who wish to speed up automation initiatives. Non-developers can also design forms, data-collection applications, business procedures, and custom user interfaces for customers using little code.

Some industry analysts and vendors of low-code systems use very different terminology, for example: Gartner uses *high-productivity application Platform-as-a-Service* (hpaPaaS).

Companies may now focus more time and money on the things that matter most, rather than designing specialized apps, thanks to low-code/no-code. In this post, we'll look at the advantages and uses of this modern marvel, which makes coding seem less daunting and allows businesses to expedite their Digital Transformation.

Here’s Why Low-Code is so Essential to Your Digital Transformation

Choose a platform that encourages cross-team collaboration by allowing application components developed for one business unit to be used in new ways by another. Synergies between teams can accelerate the delivery of all your services in this type of shared low-code environment, cutting the development cycle from months to hours and allowing your organization to function at speed. Nevertheless, it’s desire to cut costs has made it difficult for the Line of Business (LOB) to craft the kind of personalized interactions that consumers increasingly demand. In this paper, sponsored by Intense Technologies, we will look at how Low Code software development provides a way for business users to engage customers through unique and interactive communications without incurring additional expense or requiring expanded IT commitment.

Finally, your low-code solution should be able to provide end-to-end consumer-grade experiences for enterprise use cases, such as quick, intelligent self-service access to the information consumers require when they require it. And your knowledge employees must be able to promptly resolve any challenges, aided by advanced analytics and AI-assisted recommendations, all in a single, context-rich perspective. Most significantly, your low-code platform should automate and speed up critical business operations that keep customers and other stakeholders engaged with your brand. If your IT resources are constrained or if you are under pressure to reduce IT costs, consider alternative Low Code options which will allow business users to self-serve while building dynamic personalized communications such as interactive videos and responsive onboarding workflow processes. In order to meet evolving consumer needs (and particularly the preferences of younger and more affluent demographics), businesses are increasingly turning away from traditional static, document-centric communications and toward modern interactive omni-channel experiences that take advantage of video and voice.

In the context of communications, this approach enables business users to construct new touchpoints, setup business rules, design interaction workflows, or produce customer communications from pre-defined components without having to write extensive software code or employ specialist IT skills. When leveraging Low Code applications, employees with limited technical knowledge can configure everything from letters and emails to mobile apps and even personalized video using a simple “drag-and-drop” workflow without the involvement of IT. This makes the individual LOB groups much more agile, giving them greater freedom to make any necessary adjustments to their customer communications strategy without having to await budget approval or endure long development cycles, ultimately accelerating the whole organization’s progress toward desired business outcomes.

Over the last decade, consumer expectations of instant access to relevant, personalized information have made customer experience an increasingly important metric in B2C (and in many cases, B2B) communications. As a result, enterprise communication priorities have shifted from reducing cost and risk to increasing business value. With the bar being raised all the time, enterprises quickly realized that they cannot afford to neglect consumer desire for better communications without running the risk of losing customers or competitive advantage. It is for this reason that Aspire believes Customer Communications Management (CCM) has effectively become an integral part of Customer Experience Management (CXM), or the practice of managing all interactions that a business conducts with its customers with the express goal of improving the perception that customers have about that business. The promise of this transformation is an indelible shift from traditional, static outbound messaging toward more customer centric bi-directional interactions.

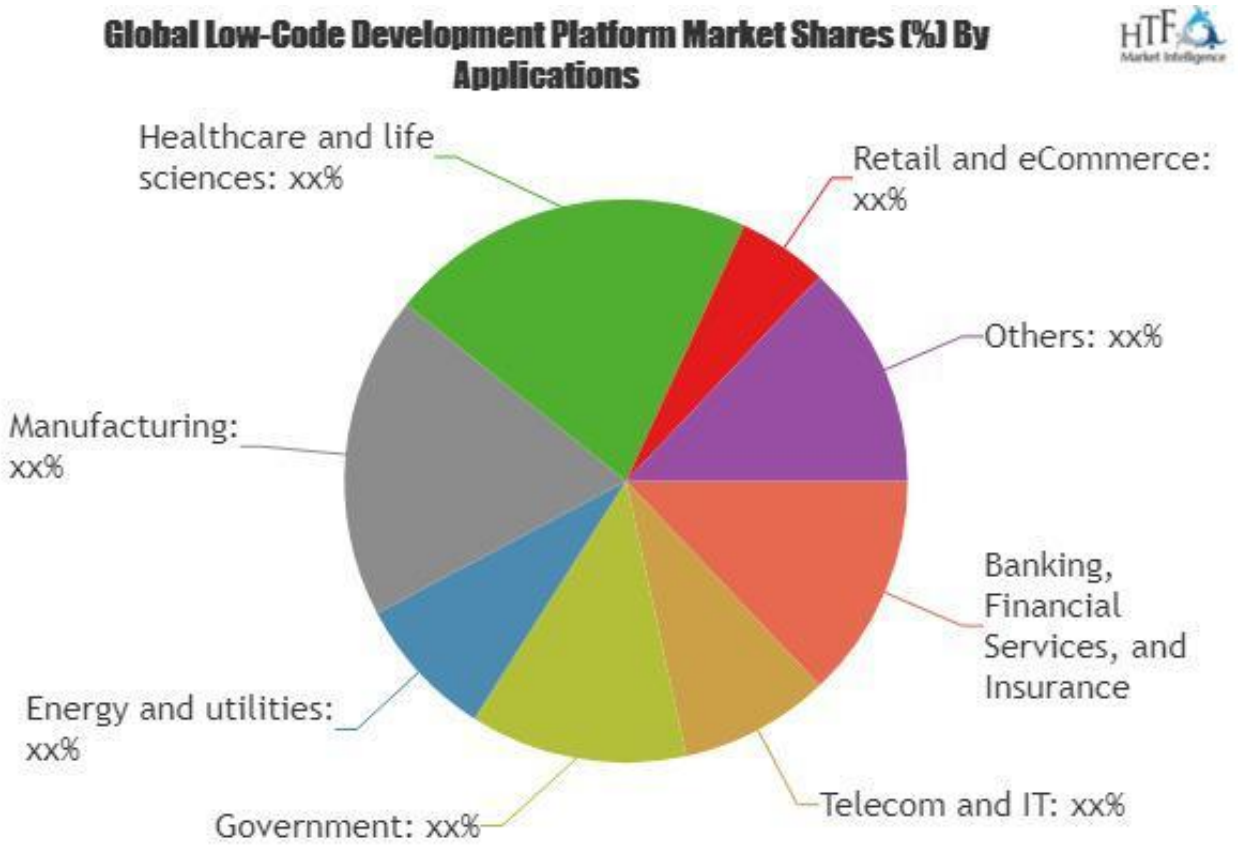
In 2019, we estimated that 60% of businesses worldwide had reached the second stage by passing customer communications strategy to the LOB or shared service. With the surge in digital adoption over the last two years, an even greater percentage have moved into the second and third categories. In other words, for the majority of organizations, the needs of the business and the demands of the customer have surpassed cost savings as the primary factor influencing CCM investment. Their focus now is on enabling business users to own communications so that they can respond more rapidly to changes in the market while supporting emerging channels and providing more relevant communications to their customers. After updating our research in the wake of COVID-19 lockdowns, we found that the profoundly disruptive effects of the pandemic and the resulting economic and cultural fallout only made customer communications more vital and business users' role in their strategic deployment that much more important.

When we asked participants about the impact the virus has had on their budgets, half reported that they have cancelled, frozen, or reduced marketing spend while around 30% have increased spending on digital transformation along with customer experience and communications. Similarly, as Figure 2 illustrates, customer retention outpaced customer acquisition to become the top communications priority for nearly all of the 300 businesses we surveyed.

A platform will only be as good as the people building and maintaining the platform. The company needs to have an active support organization and a sizeable development team that is setup for receiving and handling issues and questions. You don't want to keep your users waiting, because the developer that has the knowledge is enjoying a holiday. The type of customers the platform provider is focusing on can also determine if the development of the platform is going in a direction that you would like. For example, if a provider focuses on large enterprises and you are not one of their target customers, the provider's long-term vision and roadmap might not fit with what you need.

The Power of Low-Code Automation

Low-code platforms make it possible to design and deploy applications quickly. These platforms enable banks to offer digital products rapidly by reducing app development periods from months to days. Banks' Digital Transformation is accelerated by low-code. Low-code platforms also enable banking Omni-channels, allowing customers to complete all transactions using any digital device of their choice. Real estate investors, managers, and businesses can be relieved of the traditionally complex and time-consuming activities by using low-code platforms. They can easily design low-code apps to assist with time management, listings, finances, property portfolio management, facilities management, agent reporting, and tenant relationship management.

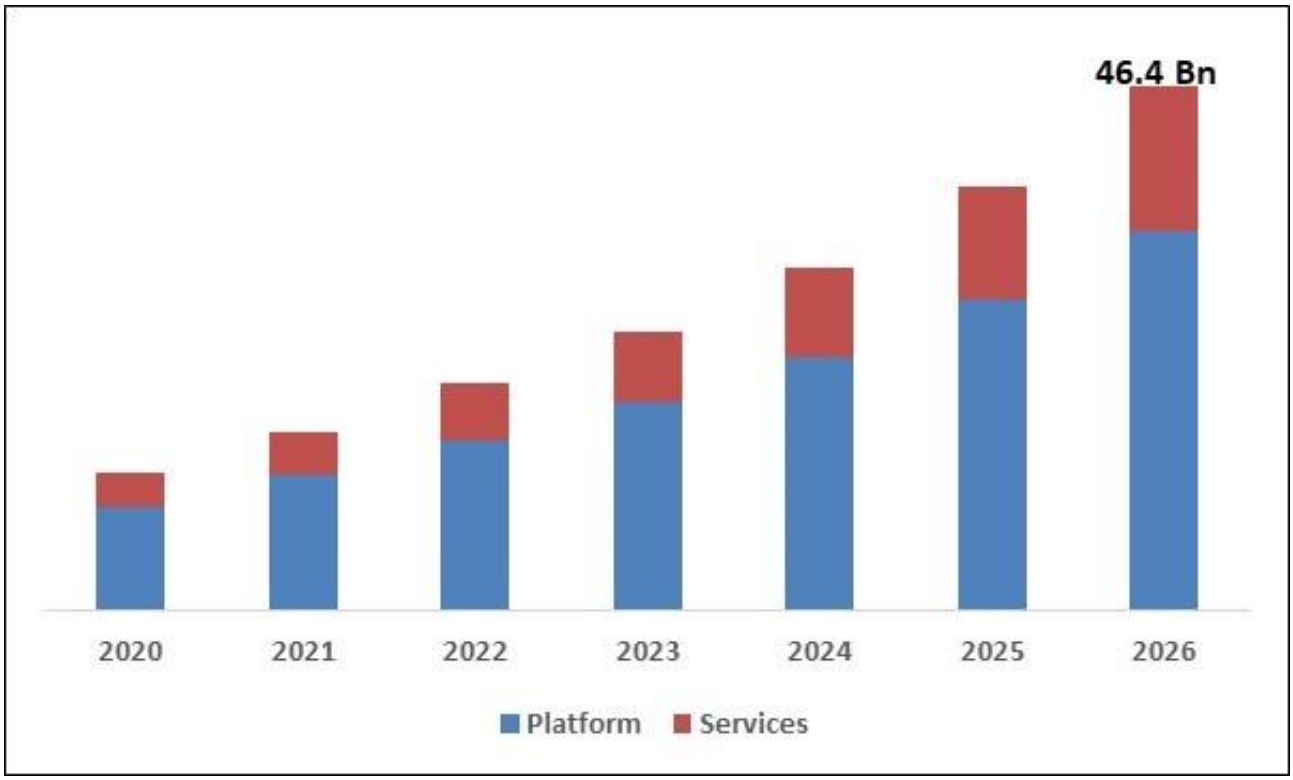


Low-code development systems centralize essential data, allowing managers to make quick choices and maximize resource use while maintaining accountability across departments.

Manufacturers have a digital opportunity to achieve operational excellence and meet the expectations of their consumers with low-code development.

Low-code is a simple yet powerful solution that provides customized and effective workflow automation and process improvement solutions. It lets construction organizations connect their data, equipment, and people to make project information more accessible. Teams can work together effortlessly on the job site or in the office while being safe, compliant, and productive. Low-code platforms provide the flexibility that such teams require to transition to new methods of working without compromising service quality. Low-code is a novel way to maintain business continuity in the event of an interruption in healthcare. It enables quick development of compliance management and monitoring apps, as well as easy API connections for standardized access and authentication management.

Due to the absence of control over the source code, low-code and no-code initiatives rely primarily on their platform providers to remedy any security problems that may be detected. There will be no security updates if these platform providers are liquidated, and firms would be unable to resolve concerns on their own. Furthermore, organizations who use low-code/no-code platform providers as hosts risk having their data and systems exposed and subject to security attacks.



The more money a company spends on a low-code/no-code platform, the more difficult it is for them to move. The business's reliance on a single provider grows as a result of this.

Selecting the Right Low-Code/No-Code Platform

It's crucial to consider whether the platform has the features your business need. Compile all of your workers' duties, such as document processing, questionnaire completion, data entry into an internal database, and so on. Form designers, electronic signatures, and other critical features must be included in the low-code platform or management software. Check if the platform can be deployed in the cloud. The application deployment procedure will be substantially faster if the low-code platform supports cloud infrastructure. It's something that should be taken advantage of.

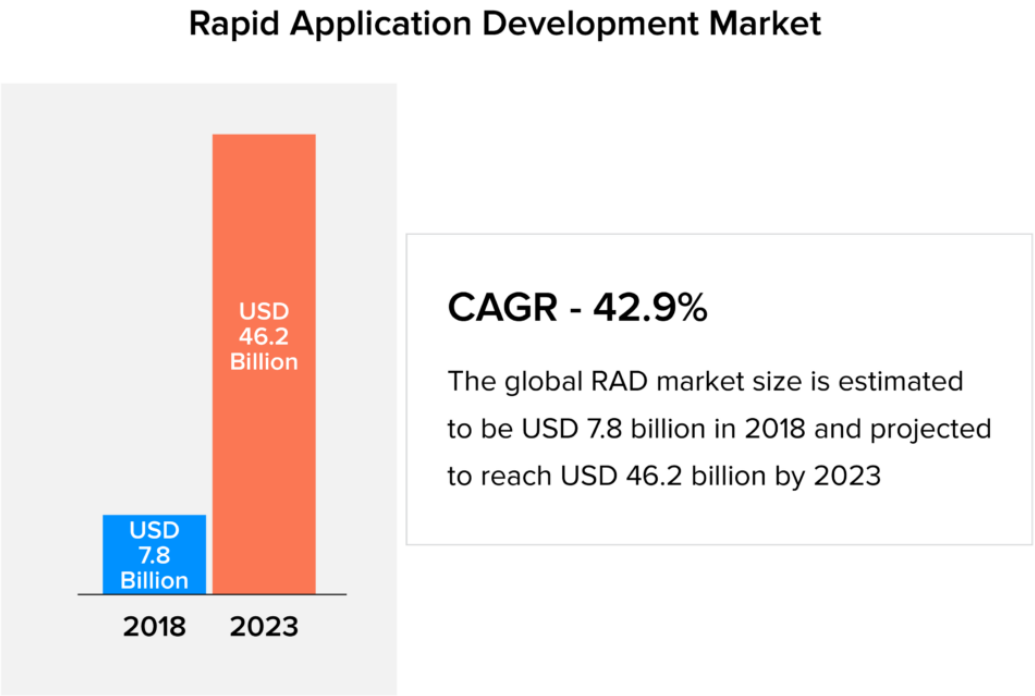
What about IT for non-coders? IT, not simply business users, should be empowered. Not everyone aspires to be a professional programmer, but everyone aspires to be a maker. Many IT workers may not be focused on serious coding abilities, but with the correct platform, they can develop fantastic apps and solutions. Companies may take advantage of and empower these IT power users by using a flexible low-code platform. Users should be able to kickstart minor problems and then progress to more complicated scenarios when they emerge with a low-code platform.

By being flexible to the diverse skill levels of a company's staff, a low-code platform may let small to medium-sized businesses experiment with new products, services, new integrations, and more. They may even create completely new systems for your company from the ground up for a fraction of the expense of dealing with an outside vendor. Ascertain that the low-code platform includes the essential configuration options and visual tools for your personnel to maintain apps on their own. For the programmed to function, it requires more than just a user-friendly interface. You'll need database access, as well as the ability to establish authentication and permissions.

Is your app user-friendly on mobile phones and tablets? Make sure your staff don't have to do anything to the app in order for it to run on mobile devices. If you want to automate company procedures, be sure the tool offers ready-made templates. Ready-made templates considerably decrease the risk of developing a system and save a considerable amount of time and work. Your low-code/no-code development team will benefit from increased productivity, flexibility, and a simple development approach. From business modeling, UI modeling, CI/CD configuration, and collaborating with various teams on application development and integrating with Agile tools like Azure DevOps, you have a range of application development possibilities.

The client, a large battery producer in Asia, wanted to build a digital warranty registration application. With iSymphonyTM , we helped jumpstart the development of features such as database authentication, user management, roles and privilege management, containerization, API documentation, in an app development project for the battery manufacturer. Using a platform costs money, otherwise the platform provider may not be around for long. Have a good look at the pricing model of the platform providers, as there are many different models.

Not all No Code platforms are likely to survive for many years. Also new companies might move into this market space that have something you really need. Although it can be easy to recreate your application or app in a new platform, if you cannot get your data and documents out of a platform then you would also have to recreate the data or documents. You may also have unhappy users due to down time or loss of data or documents or a significant period without new functionality because you are busy recreating your app / application.



For many apps / applications you probably want to use one or more data sources or your application might become a source of truth itself. This requires that a platform has integration capabilities for inbound and outbound integrations. Topics you should look into are the support for standards, like SOAP, REST and OData, the possibilities to secure connecting to / from your application. In the news there are regularly security and compliance incidents. The platform must be secure and you have to be able to trust it. Look into what kind of security certifications and measures the platform provider has put in place especially when you use a platforms own infrastructure. For compliance reason you may be restricted with respect to the storage location of the data. This could lead to instant disqualification if data is stored in the wrong location.

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